YAML

```
title: "OECD AI Principles"
issuer: "OECD"
official_source: "https://www.oecd.org/en/topics/sub-issues/ai-principles.html"
knowledge_base_status: "new-source-candidate"
notes: "International non-binding precedent; updated in 2024."
```

> Official-source transcription extracted from the official page above. Preserve source URL and verify clauses before marking them `reviewed`.

AI principles

The OECD AI Principles are the first intergovernmental standard on AI. They promote innovative, trustworthy AI that respects human rights and democratic values. Adopted in 2019 and updated in 2024, they are composed of five values-based principles and five recommendations that provide practical and flexible guidance for policymakers and AI actors.

Policy sub-issue

OECD.AI Policy Observatory

Key links

- The state of implementation of the OECD AI Principles
- The OECD AI Wonk Blog

Hands of robot and human touching

Available in: English

- English
- français

Share

Facebook Twitter LinkedIn

About the OECD AI Principles

Shaping a human-centric approach to artificial intelligence

AI offers considerable benefits in areas like healthcare, productivity and scientific progress. It also brings risks with potential disinformation, data insecurity and copyright infringement. What' s more, AI knows no borders. In this context, the principles offer a foundation for international cooperation and interoperability with guidance designed to stand the test of time in the fast-paced world of AI.

By adhering to these principles, policymakers can guide the development and deployment of AI to maximize its benefits and minimize its risks. This is crucial for harnessing the potential of AI technologies for economic growth, social welfare, and environmental sustainability while protecting individuals and societal values.

By May 2023, governments reported over 1000 policy initiatives across more than 70 jurisdictions in the OECD.AI national policy database that follow the OECD AI Principles.

Countries that adhere to the Principles

To date, the OECD AI Principles have been adopted by OECD member countries and a number of partners worldwide.

List of adherents

Values-based principles

The OECD AI Principles promote use of AI that is innovative and trustworthy and that respects human rights and democratic values. Adopted in May 2019, they set standards for AI that are practical and flexible enough to stand the test of time.

Inclusive growth, sustainable development and well-being

Stakeholders should proactively engage in responsible stewardship of trustworthy AI in pursuit of beneficial outcomes for people and the planet, such as augmenting human capabilities and enhancing creativity, advancing inclusion of underrepresented populations, reducing economic, social, gender and other inequalities, and protecting natural environments, thus invigorating inclusive growth, well-being, sustainable development and environmental sustainability.

Read more

Human rights and democratic values, including fairness and privacy

AI actors should respect the rule of law, human rights, democratic and human-centred values throughout the AI system lifecycle. These include non-discrimination and equality, freedom, dignity, autonomy of individuals, privacy and data protection, diversity, fairness, social justice, and internationally recognised labour rights. This also includes addressing misinformation and disinformation amplified by AI, while respecting freedom of expression and other rights and freedoms protected by applicable international law.

To this end, AI actors should implement mechanisms and safeguards, such as capacity for human agency and oversight, including to address risks arising from uses outside of intended purpose, intentional misuse, or unintentional misuse in a manner appropriate to the context and consistent with the state of the art.

Read more

Transparency and explainability

AI Actors should commit to transparency and responsible disclosure regarding AI systems. To this end, they should provide meaningful information, appropriate to the context, and consistent with the state of art:

- to foster a general understanding of AI systems, including their capabilities and limitations,
- to make stakeholders aware of their interactions with AI systems, including in the workplace,
- where feasible and useful, to provide plain and easy-to-understand information on the sources of data/input, factors, processes and/or logic that led to the prediction, content, recommendation or decision, to enable those affected by an AI system to understand the output, and,
- to provide information that enable those adversely affected by an AI system to challenge its output.

Read more

Robustness, security and safety

AI systems should be robust, secure and safe throughout their entire lifecycle so that, in conditions of normal use, foreseeable use or misuse, or other adverse conditions, they function appropriately and do not pose unreasonable safety and/or security risks.

Mechanisms should be in place, as appropriate, to ensure that if AI systems risk causing undue harm or exhibit undesired behaviour, they can be overridden, repaired, and/or decommissioned safely as needed.

Mechanisms should also, where technically feasible, be in place to bolster information integrity while ensuring respect for freedom of expression.

Read more

Accountability

AI actors should be accountable for the proper functioning of AI systems and for the respect of the above principles, based on their roles, the context, and consistent with the state of the art.

To this end, AI actors should ensure traceability, including in relation to datasets, processes and decisions made during the AI system lifecycle, to enable analysis of the AI system’s outputs and responses to inquiry, appropriate to the context and consistent with the state of the art.

AI actors, should, based on their roles, the context, and their ability to act, apply a systematic risk management approach to each phase of the AI system lifecycle on an ongoing basis and adopt responsible business conduct to address risks related to AI systems, including, as appropriate, via co-operation between different AI actors, suppliers of AI knowledge and AI resources, AI system users, and other stakeholders. Risks include those related to harmful bias, human rights including safety, security, and privacy, as well as labour and intellectual property rights.

Read more

Recommendations for policy makers

Investing in AI research and development

Governments should consider long-term public investment, and encourage private investment, in research and development, including interdisciplinary efforts, to spur innovation in trustworthy AI that focus on challenging technical issues and on AI-related social, legal and ethical implications and policy issues.

Governments should also consider public investment and encourage private investment in open datasets that are representative and respect privacy and data protection to support an environment for AI research and development that is free of inappropriate bias and to improve interoperability and use of standards.

Read more

Fostering an inclusive AI-enabling ecosystem

Governments should foster the development of, and access to, an inclusive, dynamic, sustainable, and interoperable digital ecosystem for trustworthy AI. Such an ecosystem includes inter alia, data, AI technologies, computational and connectivity infrastructure, and mechanisms for sharing AI knowledge, as appropriate. In this regard, governments should consider promoting mechanisms, such as data trusts, to support the safe, fair, legal and ethical sharing of data.

Read more

Shaping an enabling interoperable governance and policy environment for AI

Governments should promote an agile policy environment that supports transitioning from the research and development stage to the deployment and operation stage for trustworthy AI systems. To this effect, they should consider using experimentation to provide a controlled environment in which AI systems can be tested, and scaled-up, as appropriate. They should also adopt outcome-based approaches that provide flexibility in achieving governance objectives and co-operate within and across jurisdictions to promote interoperable governance and policy environments, as appropriate.

Governments should review and adapt, as appropriate, their policy and regulatory frameworks and assessment mechanisms as they apply to AI systems to encourage innovation and competition for trustworthy AI.

Read more

Building human capacity and preparing for labour market transformation

Governments should work closely with stakeholders to prepare for the transformation of the world of work and of society. They should empower people to effectively use and interact with AI systems across the breadth of applications, including by equipping them with the necessary skills.

Governments should take steps, including through social dialogue, to ensure a fair transition for workers as AI is deployed, such as through training programmes along the working life, support for those affected by displacement, including through social protection, and access to new opportunities in the labour market.

Governments should also work closely with stakeholders to promote the responsible use of AI at work, to enhance the safety of workers, the quality of jobs and of public services, to foster entrepreneurship and productivity, and aim to ensure that the benefits from AI are broadly and fairly shared.

Read more

International co-operation for trustworthy AI

Governments, including developing countries and with stakeholders, should actively co-operate to advance these principles and to progress on responsible stewardship of trustworthy AI.

Governments should work together in the OECD and other global and regional fora to foster the sharing of AI knowledge, as appropriate. They should encourage international, cross-sectoral and open multi-stakeholder initiatives to garner long-term expertise on AI.

Governments should promote the development of multi-stakeholder, consensus-driven global technical standards for interoperable and trustworthy AI.

Governments should also encourage the development, and their own use, of internationally comparable indicators to measure AI research, development and deployment, and gather the evidence base to assess progress in the implementation of these principles.

Read more

Latest insights

See all

- Blog

  Innovation and trust: Why AI needs both

  25 September 2026

  6 min read

- External blog

  Putting agentic AI systems to work: What practitioners reveal about deployment and governance

  oecd.ai

  24 September 2026

- External blog

  Turning ambition into action: How the OECD is engaging at the India AI Impact Summit

  oecd.ai

  18 February 2026

- External blog

  A dynamic dialogue with Southeast Asia to put the OECD AI Principles into action

oecd.ai

10 September 2025

- Press release

  OECD launches pilot to monitor application of G7 code of conduct on advanced AI development

  22 July 2024

- External blog

  How countries are implementing the OECD Principles for Trustworthy AI

  oecd.ai

  31 October 2023

Related publications

See all publications

- Report

  Digital Government Outlook 2026

  15 June 2026

  184 Pages

- Report

  Benefits of AI openness

  OECD discussion paper for the G7

  29 May 2026

  37 Pages

- Report

  OECD Due Diligence Guidance for Responsible AI

  19 February 2026

  61 Pages

- Report

  The OECD.AI Index

  19 February 2026

  56 Pages

- Report

» AI adoption by small and medium-sized enterprises

OECD discussion paper for the G7

9 December 2025

62 Pages

- Report

  » G7 Toolkit for Artificial Intelligence in the Public Sector

  15 October 2024

  92 Pages

Related policy issues

- » AI and work

  Rapid developments in artificial intelligence (AI) are beginning to have an impact on the world of work, with potentially far-reaching consequences for countries, firms and businesses. There is an urgent need for policies that allow everyone to benefit from these changes, while also addressing potential risks.

  Learn more

- » AI compute

  As artificial intelligence grows, so does the need for the large-scale computer resources behind it. Resources for training and deploying AI, often called “AI compute”, require powerful hardware. But with growing demand for AI compute, questions about national capacities to achieve AI strategies are arising.

  Learn more

- » AI risks and incidents

  Artificial intelligence promises tremendous benefits but also carries real risks. Some of these risks are already materialising into harms to people and societies: bias and discrimination, polarisation of opinions, privacy infringements, and security and safety issues. Trustworthy AI calls for governments worldwide to develop interoperable risk-based approaches to AI governance and a rigorous understanding of AI incidents and hazards.

  Learn more

- » Artificial intelligence and education and skills

  As AI rapidly advances, it is crucial to understand how education will be affected. Important questions to consider include: How can AI be compared to humans? How do AI systems perform tasks from various capability domains such as language, reasoning,

sensorimotor or social interaction domains? What are the implications for education and training?

Learn more

- Digital divide in education

  The digital divide signifies unequal access to digital technologies, particularly concerning internet connectivity and device availability, alongside disparities in infrastructure, skills and affordability. These gaps result in unequal opportunities for information access and digital participation.

  Learn more

- Digital education

  Data and digital technologies such as Artificial Intelligence (AI) are powerful drivers of innovation in education, offering transformative opportunities for system and school management as well as for teaching and learning. However, they also create policy issues, such as equity concerns and interoperability, that countries need to mitigate.

  Learn more

- Generative AI

  Generative AI (GenAI) is a category of AI that can create new content such as text, images, videos and music. It gained global attention in 2022 with text-to-image generators and large language models (LLMs). While GenAI has the potential to revolutionise entire industries and society, it also poses critical challenges and considerations that policymakers must confront.

  Learn more

oecd

© Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development

Topics

All Topics

Countries & regions

All Countries

Regional and global engagement

Data

- Indicators
- Dashboards & Tools

Publications

- Reports
- Policy briefs

News & Events

- Newsroom
- Events
- Blogs & podcasts

Social media links

- Facebook
- Twitter
- Youtube
- LinkedIn
- Instagram
- Newsletters
- Podcast
- Whatsapp

Utility links

- Terms & Conditions
- Privacy Policy

Go to top